PORTUGUESE-ENGLISH TEACHING ASSISTANT PHRASES

Essential Language Guide for Mathematics Education

A practical reference for English speakers supporting Portuguese mathematics instruction

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TOP 10 ESSENTIAL PHRASES FOR TEACHING ASSISTANTS

1. **Checking Understanding / Verificar Compreensão**

English: "Do you understand this concept?"
Portuguese: "Entendes este conceito?"
Pronunciation: [en-TEN-desh ESH-teh kon-SAY-too]

Alternative: "Faz sentido?" (Does it make sense?)
Pronunciation: [fash sen-TEE-doo]

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2. **Offering Help / Oferecer Ajuda**

English: "Do you need help with this problem?"
Portuguese: "Precisas de ajuda com este problema?"
Pronunciation: [preh-SEE-zash deh ah-ZHOO-dah kom ESH-teh pro-BLEH-mah]

Alternative: "Posso ajudar?" (Can I help?)
Pronunciation: [POH-soo ah-zhoo-DAR]

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3. **Encouraging Exploration / Encorajar Exploração**

English: "Let's try a different approach"
Portuguese: "Vamos tentar uma abordagem diferente"
Pronunciation: [VAH-moosh ten-TAR OO-mah ah-bor-DAH-zhem dee-feh-REN-teh]

Simple version: "Vamos tentar de outro modo" (Let's try another way)
Pronunciation: [VAH-moosh ten-TAR deh OH-troo MOH-doo]

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4. **Visual Learning Support / Apoio Visual**

English: "Let me show you visually"
Portuguese: "Deixa-me mostrar-te visualmente"
Pronunciation: [DAY-shah-meh mosh-TRAR-teh vee-zoo-al-MEN-teh]

Alternative: "Vou desenhar para ti" (I'll draw it for you)
Pronunciation: [voh deh-zen-YAHR pah-rah tee]

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5. **Explaining Steps / Explicar Passos**

English: "Let's break this into steps"
Portuguese: "Vamos dividir isto em passos"
Pronunciation: [VAH-moosh dee-vee-DEER ISH-too em PAH-soosh]

Alternative: "Passo a passo" (Step by step)
Pronunciation: [PAH-soo ah PAH-soo]

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6. **Positive Reinforcement / Reforço Positivo**

English: "Very good! You're getting it!"
Portuguese: "Muito bem! Estás a perceber!"
Pronunciation: [MWEE-too bem! esh-TASH ah per-seh-BER]

Alternative: "Excelente trabalho!" (Excellent work!)
Pronunciation: [esh-seh-LEN-teh trah-BAH-lyoo]

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7. **Redirecting Focus / Redirecionar Foco**

English: "Let's focus on this part first"
Portuguese: "Vamos focar nesta parte primeiro"
Pronunciation: [VAH-moosh foh-KAR NESH-tah PAR-teh pree-MAY-roo]

Simple: "Primeiro isto" (This first)
Pronunciation: [pree-MAY-roo ISH-too]

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8. **Mathematical Language / Linguagem Matemática**

English: "This is called..." / "We call this..."
Portuguese: "Isto chama-se..." / "Chamamos a isto..."
Pronunciation: [ISH-too SHAH-mah-seh] / [shah-MAH-moosh ah ISH-too]

Alternative: "O nome disto é..." (The name of this is...)
Pronunciation: [oo NOH-meh DESH-too eh]

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9. **Problem-Solving Guidance / Orientação na Resolução**

English: "What do you think comes next?"
Portuguese: "O que achas que vem a seguir?"
Pronunciation: [oo keh AH-shash keh vem ah seh-GEER]

Alternative: "E agora?" (And now?)
Pronunciation: [eh ah-GOH-rah]

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10. **Time Management / Gestão do Tempo**

English: "We have a few more minutes"
Portuguese: "Temos mais alguns minutos"
Pronunciation: [TEH-moosh mah-eesh al-GOOSH mee-NOO-toosh]

Alternative: "Quase a acabar" (Almost finished)
Pronunciation: [KWAH-zeh ah ah-kah-BAR]

BONUS MATHEMATICAL VOCABULARY

Core Mathematical Terms / Termos Matemáticos Básicos

English	Portuguese	Pronunciation
Number	Número	[NOO-meh-roo]
Addition	Adição	[ah-dee-SAH-oo]
Subtraction	Subtração	[soob-trah-SAH-oo]
Multiplication	Multiplicação	[mool-tee-plee-kah-SAH-oo]
Division	Divisão	[dee-vee-ZAH-oo]
Fraction	Fração	[frah-SAH-oo]
Equation	Equação	[eh-kwah-SAH-oo]
Solution	Solução	[soh-loo-SAH-oo]
Graph	Gráfico	[GRAH-fee-koo]
Angle	Ângulo	[AN-goo-loo]

Student Names from Context

- **Maria** [mah-REE-ah]
- **Pietro** [pee-EH-troo]
- **Victor** [VEEK-tor]
- **Julia** [ZHOO-lee-ah]
- **Suri** [SOO-ree]

CONTEXT-SPECIFIC PHRASES

Working with Danielle (Primary Teacher)

English: "Should I explain the visual part?"
Portuguese: "Devo explicar a parte visual?"
Pronunciation: [DEH-voo esh-plee-KAR ah PAR-teh vee-zoo-AHL]

During Presentations

English: "Let's look at this poster together"
Portuguese: "Vamos ver este cartaz juntos"
Pronunciation: [VAH-moosh ver ESH-teh kar-TASH ZHOON-toosh]

Project Consultation

English: "How can we apply math to your project?"
Portuguese: "Como podemos aplicar matemática ao teu projeto?"
Pronunciation: [KOH-moo poh-DEH-moosh ah-plee-KAR mah-teh-MAH-tee-kah ah-oo teh-oo pro-ZHEH-too]

PRONUNCIATION TIPS

Key Sound Patterns:

- **ão** = [AH-oo] (like "ow" in "how")
- **nh** = [ny] (like "gn" in "lasagna")
- **lh** = [ly] (like "lli" in "million")
- **ch** = [sh] (like "sh" in "ship")
- **r** at beginning = rolled R
- **rr** = strongly rolled R

Stress Patterns:

- Words ending in vowels: stress second-to-last syllable
- Words ending in consonants: stress last syllable
- Accents mark exceptions

EMERGENCY PHRASES

"I speak more English" = "Falo mais inglês"
[FAH-loo mah-eesh in-GLESH]

"Can you repeat slowly?" = "Podes repetir devagar?"
[POH-desh reh-peh-TEER deh-vah-GAR]

"I'm still learning Portuguese" = "Ainda estou a aprender português"
[ah-EEN-dah esh-TOH ah ah-pren-DER por-too-GESH]

This guide supports the bilingual mathematics education environment described in the OMSN Teaching Manual, enabling effective collaboration between English-speaking teaching assistants and Portuguese-speaking students.